

TVs TO BUY UNDER 50K

- **Vu 55K160GAU:** Bang for the buck, get a 55-inch panel for less than 50K. Full HD, 1920 x 1080
3 x HDMI, 2 x USB
- **LG 40UF670T:** Going 4K on a budget, supports local dimming and offers 4K@60fps. Ultra HD (4K), 3840 x 2160
2 x HDMI, 1 x USB
- **LG 43LF6300:** Feature rich, plenty of connectivity options, runs on Web OS 2.0. Full HD, 1920 x 1080
Smart TV
3 x HDMI, 3 x USB
Wi-Fi Direct, Ethernet

thing. The minimum refresh rate that you should settle for on any LED TV you buy should be at least 50/60 Hz at all resolutions supported.

DON'T BOTHER WITH 3D

Yup, nothing much to say here, unless the 3D feature comes at no extra cost, don't go hunting specifically for a 3D TV. Content is sparse, implementation is sub-par and 3D is best left and experienced in theatres.

CURVED AND OLED SCREENS

OLED TVs do offer the best picture quality in terms of colours, contrast, black levels and also response time. If you are

sitting on wads of cash, go ahead and splurge on that OLED TV. It will definitely give you the best visual experience.

Curved screens on the other hand are more of a technological achievement rather than a market need. The impact of curved screens is limited to 55-inch screens and upwards in our book, the impact itself isn't substantial enough to justify the price difference. Having said that, curved TVs do look awesome and will go a long way in enhancing the aesthetic value of your room. But if you want the best value for your money, curved and OLED TVs aren't recommended at their current price points. Even though they do offer the best overall picture quality, OLED TVs are expected to get cheaper and better over the next two years.

SOUND

The race towards slimmer, lighter, TVs has resulted in slimmer, lighter TVs that sound like crap. And, in most cases the sound quality from big screen TVs will be adequate at best. There are certain exceptions, the Sony W950C series for example offers pretty good sound quality out of the box. But, it also demands a heavy premium for doing that. If you aren't going to attach extra set of speakers/home theatre to your TV, we strongly recommend you to thoroughly test (more on this later) the sound quality of the TV at the store before making your final decision. Poor sound quality can heavily mar the final

TVs TO BUY UNDER 1L

- **Sony 50W900B:** Excellent image quality, feature rich, good sound quality, offers local dimming. Full HD, 1920 x 1080
3D TV, Smart TV
4 x HDMI, 3 x USB
Built-in Wi-Fi, Ethernet
- **LG 49LF540A:** Inexpensive, IPS panel, great value. Full HD, 1920 x 1080
2 x HDMI, 1 x USB
- **Samsung 48JU6470:** Big screen UHD 4K TV with all the bells and whistles under 1L. Ultra HD (4K), 3840 x 2160
Smart TV
4 x HDMI, 3 x USB

experience of a big screen TV, we've come across numerous examples of frustrated buyers who are in utter disbelief of how the sound output from their big screen TV is weak and highly suppressed in terms of quality and sound stage.

ALSO CONSIDER BUYING FROM GREY MARKET CAN BE SUICIDAL

Don't, just don't get lured by those crazy good deals offered in the grey channels. Those TVs might be new and absolutely genuine, but should something go wrong with them, you will end up paying through your nose to fix them. Modern LED TVs can't be fixed at your local repair shops and official sales and support folks will charge you a bomb to fix any panel related issues. The only math that works in favour of buying from the grey market is if the price you pay works out to be 70 percent lower than the best price you get via the official retail channel. And, that will never be the case. Therefore, stick to genuine, official stuff that comes with manufacturer warranty.

DEPRECIATION AND RESALE

Given the relatively long upgrade cycles for TVs, you don't really have to worry about depreciation. In case you do find a need to upgrade within two years of buying a new TV, don't expect more than 30 percent of the purchase price in return. Many online retailers like Flipkart and Snapdeal do offer some pretty good exchange deals during their overly-hyped online sales. 



The downsides of slim panels is poor sound